Unit 1 - Communication and Employability in IT
Assignment 6

Introduction

Scenario / Vocational Context: *As part of your continuing professional development ("**CPD**"), your careers advisor asked you to complete a personal development plan. Since completing the plan they would now like you to undertake a review of your own experiences, which evaluate your own Personal Development*

P8 - Follow a personal development plan

Task description: *You will need to re-submit your personal development plan, you will need to show you have been following your plan. You should provide evidence that you have achieved or attempted to achieve at least **five** short term targets and set at least **five** new short term targets. Although it is expected that you would have done more than five.*

Review of your personal development plan

Where am I now?

I am now in the second term at my college and I am studying BTEC Level 3 Extended Diploma in IT and iGCSE English as a second language. On my esubs website, which is a website that records and predicts the grades of assignments, I see that the predicted grades I am getting are mostly green (which means it's a full mark) and little to no yellows (which is an indicator that means more efficient work needs to be done).

On my IT course, I have learned a significant amount of knowledge towards computers when compared to the time I was doing my GCSEs. I learned many topics such as: coding with Visual Basic, HTML, CSS and JavaScript; Learning the more unknown components and wiring within a PC; how PC connect to each other using networks and other forms of connections and how the progression of technology impacts the human race and its future.

During the IT course in college, I used my knowledge of the BTEC subjects I did during my time in year 10 and 11. Such as how the grading system in BTEC works, how to layout assignments so it is easy to read and mark and basically how the system works compared to GCSE.

The assignments and advice from lecturers that has been given to me also improved my english vocabulary and other written communication skills that I previously found quite challenging to do.

Where do I want to be?

After I finish my IT course in college, I am aiming to go to a university to study in the field of Robotics Specialization. The reason I have picked this particular area to study is due to the fact I have always loved working with machinery, especially when I get to mess around with the parts and dismantle it.

I also believe that this area is going to be greatly improved in the future thanks to AI and other forms of robotics replacing the needs for humans in some areas of the world wide industry, for example, car manufacturing.

Previous short term goals

Finish my assignments earlier	Manage my time better	Reduce anxiety and stress	Keep my CV updated	Stay away from stressful situations

Previous short term goals table

SMART		Goals				
		Finish my assignments earlier	Manage my time better	Reduce anxiety and stress	Keep my CV updated	Stay away from stressful situations
Specific	Who? What? When? Which? Why?	My goal is to complete the assignments earlier when I am given them and complete it until at least 3 days before the deadline so I can reduce the stress and increase the quality of the work.	My goal is to manage the time better so that I could do each activity on the day in order and that I attend college in time so I can increase my punctuality and reduce time wasting.	My goal is to reduce the anxiety and stress when doing work by doing calm activities and that I balance my free time and work time so that I could concentrate better and produce better work.	My goal is to update my CV by updating it in 2 months or in a 2 week schedule so I can use it for employment or other purposes such as applying for a university.	My goal is to reduce the income of stress by going to quiet and clean places when doing work so I can reduce stress while working and increase work quality.
Measurable	How will I know when it is accomplished?	I will know when this is accomplished when I have finished the assignment before its deadline.	I will measure my progress by checking the schedule and the time to see if they sync properly.	I will measure my progress by checking my stress and anxiety when doing my assignments.	I will know when this is accomplished when I have completed my CV within the 2 week schedule or in 2 months.	I will know this is accomplished when I have found a place where I could work properly without getting stressed from noise and unease.
Attainable	How to achieve the short term goals	In order to complete this short term goal I need to be	To achieve this goal I need to have a daily schedule on	To achieve this goal I will have to take regular breaks	To achieve this short term goal I have to update my	To achieve this goal I have to find a good quiet and clean

		determined to do the assignments as early as possible.	a planner or on a device.	between work or do work earlier prior to the deadline.	CV on a scheduled time.	working area to do my assignments.
Realistic and Relevant	Importance of achieving the short term goal and whether I am willing and able to achieve it.	To make this realistic I would have to make the priority to finish at least 3 days before the deadline. The importance of this is so I don't leave work for the last minute and stress takes over the workload, which often replaces common sense and/or the understandin g of the work, which produces bad quality work.	To make this goal realistic I would have to give myself enough time for work, free time and other essentials such as sleeping and eating. The importance of achieving this short term goal is so that I have an organised schedule and a proper flow of work and time.	To make this goal realistic I would have to calm down over time instead of only doing it before an assignment. The importance of achieving this is so that all the anxiety and stress doesn't get in the way of a good quality work, with stress and anxiety I would just focus on completing it instead of providing good quality.	To make this realistic I would have to schedule the CV in a time where it doesn't interfere with other activities, such as every 2 weeks or in 2 months. The importance of this short term goal is so that the CV gets updated for employment or even university applications. Updating it constantly could help put down key skills or activities that may be forgotten.	To make this goal realistic I would have to choose a place where it is better to work than other places instead of finding the perfect stress free location. This is important because having little to no stress could impact the output of work significantly, and if I work in a place that causes little to no stress my work output would be much better than if I had a lot of stress.
Time based	When the short term goal has to be achieved	This short term goal has to be achieved when I get get given an assignment with a due in date.	This short term goal has to be achieved within approximatel y 2 weeks.	This short term goal isn't a very time based goal but it can be completed as soon as possible, which would take weeks or even months.	This short term goal can be achieved within 1 to 2 months from today, but it can be constantly updated every 2 weeks if scheduled.	This short term goal could be completed within a day or, at most, a week.

Where the goals achieved?

Weeks (date	Finish my	Manage my	Reduce	Keep my CV	Stay away

is presented in every Sunday)	assignments earlier	time better	anxiety and stress	updated	from stressful situations
27/11/2016	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has not yet been attempted	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
4/12/2016	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
11/12/2016	This goal has been attempted but not completed due to assignments being handed in very close to the deadline.	This goal has not yet been attempted	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal has not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.
18/12/2016	This goal has not yet been attempted due to holidays.	This goal has not yet been attempted due to holidays.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has not yet been attempted due to holidays.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
25/12/2016	This goal has not yet been attempted due to	This goal has not yet been attempted due to	This goal has been attempted and the	This goal has been attempted but not	This goal has been attempted and the

	holidays.	holidays.	results were positive.	completed.	results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
1/1/2017	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
8/1/2017	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal had not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
15/1/2017	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal had not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.
22/1/2017	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal had not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
29/1/2017	This goal has been attempted but not completed due to	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so	This goal had not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so

	assignments being handed in very close to the deadline.	the goal was achieved.	the goal was achieved.		the goal was achieved.
5/2/2017	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal had not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.
12/2/2017	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.
19/2/2017	This goal has been attempted but not completed due to assignments being handed in very close to the deadline.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal has been attempted but not achieved.	This goal had not yet been attempted.	This goal has been attempted but not completed.
26/2/2017	This goal has not yet been attempted due to holidays.	This goal has not yet been attempted due to holidays.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.	This goal has been attempted and the results were positive, so the goal was achieved.
Conclusion					

The reason I have set these goals is because I felt they were both important and achievable. The reason I thought they were important was because I felt that these goals would really improve my college life and career because I can reach my full potential with these goals.

With the first goal, I wanted to set the goal of finishing my assignments earlier because I get very stressed out when the deadline gets closer, and I tend to not include quality in my work when I am stressed out because I focus on finishing it instead of answering it.

With the second goal, I wanted to manage my time better because I don't usually organise my own time even though I know I should. So I forced myself to make this goal so I can have a fine balance between work and free time.

With the third goal, I wanted to reduce the amount of anxiety and stress I got because I very usually get stressed and filled with anxiety when I have to carry out a very important task, the reason for this is purely because I fear for the consequences that might happen if something goes completely wrong. So, reducing this would be very beneficial for my course.

With the fourth goal I wanted to keep my CV updated so I can use it just incase there is a part time job offer available and to prepare it for university. I feel that updating the CV is very important because it can be used as a first impression towards a potential employer, and the first impression is usually the most important one, especially for an employer.

With the fifth goal, I wanted to keep away from stressful situations. This seems very similar to the third goal but it actually is different,. By that I mean that I keep away from situations that are stress inducing, instead of actually reducing the amount of stress I have. I felt that this goal is important because assignments in this course are already stressful enough to do, and having other forms of stress on top of that would really bring down my motivation to work and reduce the quality of the assignments.

Overall, I felt that these goals would be very beneficial to my first term of the course in college because it help me improve in areas that i have a weakness in and it also helps bring out hidden weaknesses and other weaknesses that I haven't considered within myself.

With the completion of the goals I think I did do reasonably well. However, I did not do my full potential because I sometimes lost track or laid back too much because of the holidays. At least there were times in which I did complete these goals

Revised goals

Get a part time job as soon as possible.	Update CV and personal statemen t for	Achieve at least a Merit and at most a Distinctio	Achieve at least a B and at most an A* for the	Improve verbal and written communi	Improve in stress manage ment.	Continue finishing my assignm	Search and apply for universiti es to

	university applicatio n.	n* on the IT course.	iGCSE English.	cation skills.		ents earlier	study my desired course.

I revised my previous goals because I have achieved some of the goals and I have been given advice and feedback from some lecturers on what to improve from. So I decided to borrow the advice and also find other weaknesses that I have encountered throughout the course.

I also found that I needed to apply for a university and find a part time job as soon as possible so that I get the best advantage in getting into the university and with enough money for myself so I can help add funds towards the university payment.

I believe that the revised goals will be a lot more important than the previous ones because I am reaching the stage in life where I am going from college education into a university course so I can find future employment, where I hopefully find a job that I will enjoy doing or at least get enough money to survive from.

Revised goals table

SMART		Goals							
		Get a part time job as soon as possible.	Update CV and personal statemen t for university applicatio n.	Achieve at least a Merit and at most a Distinctio n* on the IT course.	Achieve at least a B and at most an A* for the iGCSE English.	Improve verbal and written communi cation skills.	Improve in stress and anxiety manage ment.	Continue finishing my assignme nts earlier	Search and apply for universiti es to study my desired course.
Specific	Who? What? When? Which? Why?	My goal is to find a part time employm ent as soon as possible, preferabl y within the summer holidays, so I can gain enough income to help fund the money for my future university ,	My goal is to update my CV by updating it in 2 months or in a 2 week schedule so I can increase the chance of getting an applicatio n for a university .	My goal is to achieve at most a Distinctio n* by the end of the first year in college so I can have an impressio nable grade to show to the university in which I will apply for or a potential employer .	My goal is to at most an A* by the end of the first year in college so I can have an impressio nable grade to show to the university in which I will apply for or a potential employer	My goal is to improve my verbal and written communi cation skills througho ut this year so I can use it to improve my written assignme nts, examinati ons and my CV for	My goal is to improve on the manage ment of my stress and anxiety as soon as possible, preferabl y within a month's time maximu m, so I can do my assignme nts and exams with full	My goal is to still complete the assignme nts earlier when I am given them and complete it until at least 2-3 days before the deadline so I can reduce the stress and increase the	My goal is to to search and apply for many different universiti es, before decembe r this year, so I can apply to many as possible and increase the chance of getting in.

						university application.	potential.	quality of the work.	
Measurable	How will I know when it is accomplished?	I will know this goal will be complete once I have found a part time job which has accepted me and I am working for that company as a part time.	I will know this goal is completed once I am fully satisfied with my CV to be sent off to a university so I can be applied.	I will know this goal will be accomplished once I get the full, vitrified Merit to Distinction* grade for my Level 3 IT course.	I will know this goal will be accomplished once I get the full, vitrified B to A* grade for my IGCSE course.	I will know this goal will be completed once I notice that my vocabulary for my verbal and written communication has improved when compared previously.	I will know this goal will be accomplished once I become less stressed while doing assignments and exams.	I will know when this is accomplished when I have finished the assignment before its deadline.	I will know this goal is completed once I get emails or letters from the applied university/universities saying that I have been accepted.
Attainable	How to achieve the goals	To achieve this goal I will have to create my CV, personal statement and to find then apply to a local, vacant part time job.	To achieve this goal I will have to write out my CV appropriate to a potential employer or university so I can have the chance of being selected.	To achieve this goal I have to make sure to write assignments with better quality, with less stress and more time so I keep the good progress I have at the moment in the momentum and achieve the highest potential grade I could achieve.	To achieve this goal I will have to revise in english so I can improve my expertise on the language, so when I am doing the exam I will know a lot more about it than I previously did.	To achieve this goal I will have to read, write and speak to people much more often so I get to learn new vocabulary from others while also getting into the habit of speaking and writing much more efficiently.	To achieve this goal I will have to take regular breaks between work or do work earlier prior to the deadline.	In order to complete this goal I need to be determined to do the assignments as early as possible.	To achieve this goal I need to be determined and have the confidence to apply to the most available universities as possible.
Realistic and Relevant	Importance of achieving the goal and	To make this goal realistic I would have to	To make this goal realistic I would have to	To make this goal realistic I will have to make	To make sure this goal is realistic I will have	To make this goal realistic I will have to make	To make this goal realistic I would have to	To make this realistic I would have to	To make this goal realistic, I would have to

	whether I am willing and able to achieve it.	make sure I get this part time job when I am the least busiest with college work. The importance of achieving this is so I can get enough money so I can use the funds I attained from it to help fund the university course.	make this CV in a time where I am free and not filled with the stress of work, preferably over the weekend or the holidays. The importance of this is so I can use the CV for future employment or university application.	sure that I have enough time to actually add quality into assignments without stress, instead of doing every assignment last minute which can become a bad habit. This is important because if I do leave it to the last minute I will be filled with stress and start producing bad quality work, which means that the grades will potentially not be met.	to study a long time before exams before doing it on the last few weeks or last months trying to cram information and then forgetting what i have revised due to stress and not do my full potential within exams. This is important because if I do leave it to the last minute I will be filled with stress and start producing bad quality work, which means that the grades will potentially not be met.	sure I don't spend all the time reading, writing and listening to the point of replacing free time or work time. I have to do this within short bursts so I can slowly but surely improve my vocabulary. The importance of this is so I can use this to my advantage when writing important documents such as assignments, CV or personal statement and when talking to important individuals such as employers.	calm down over time instead of only doing it before an assignment. The importance of achieving this is so that all the anxiety and stress doesn't get in the way of a good quality work, with stress and anxiety I would just focus on completing it instead of providing good quality.	make the priority to finish at least 3 days before the deadline. The importance of this is so I don't leave work for the last minute and stress takes over the workload, which often replaces common sense and/or the understanding of the work, which produces bad quality work.	do it when I am not extremely busy and to do it before the deadline for university application. The importance of achieving this is so I can actually improve my education and increase the chance of getting a potential, decent future employment.
Time based	When the goal has to be achieved	This goal will have to be achieved as soon as possible, however I am hoping that I achieve	Just like the university application, This goal has to be achieved before December this year	This goal isn't a very time based goal because I have no control over the time I have to give this	This goal isn't a very time based goal because I have no control over the time I have to give this	This goal isn't a very time based goal but it can be completed as soon as possible, which would	This goal has to be achieved within at most a month's time so I can deal with more assignments and	This goal has to be achieved when I get get given an assignment with a due in date.	This goal has to be achieved before December this year because it is when the applications for

		this before or during the summer holidays.	because it is when the applications for universities.	in by but it can be completed.	in by but it can be completed.	take weeks or even months.	exams with a significantly less amount of stress.		universities.